

Alla Vostra Mobile App Work Log - August 12, 2026 (Part 2)

Compiled summary for Wednesday, August 12, 2026 (Part 2) - focus: post-Part-1 startup tutorial polish, exact smiley storyboard asset import, Pillow-based badge and gradient cleanup, generated 48-frame sprite atlas, Reanimated/Worklets installation, Got It button animation gating, Android Worklets rebuild verification, native splash background persistence, final-frame hold timing, swipe-hand hint reset cleanup, project snapshot refresh, and current documentation artifact generation for Alla Vostra.

Generated in continuity with the established Alla Vostra worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline, goals, grouped work-completed sections, validation, files touched, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact is named `alla_vostra_worklog_august12_part2.pdf` because the repository already contained an August 12 root-level worklog after the first startup-splash pass. That earlier file has now been renamed to `alla_vostra_worklog_august12_part1.pdf` so the two August 12 documentation artifacts follow the same root-level part-suffix convention used by August 10, July 7, July 2, June 6, May 25, and May 30. This Part 2 record covers the work window after the August 12 Part 1 PDF worklog commit `5a7db8e`, through the current committed source state at `edcee75` Added polished tutorial Got It animation flow.

Source Material Reviewed

- Reviewed all 56 pre-existing root-level Alla Vostra PDF worklogs, spanning the early website logs from May, the mobile-app migration and Android responsiveness logs from May and June, the July checkout and Play Store readiness logs, August 1, August 10 Parts 1-3, August 11, and the original August 12 worklog.
- Extracted recent PDFs with `pdftotext` and inspected PDF metadata with `pdftinfo` to preserve the current title format, part-number naming, letter-size page output, footer behavior, section ordering, bullet density, validation language, and output-artifact wording.
- Used `alla_vostra_worklog_august12.pdf` as the closest immediate style anchor because it documented the first August 12 startup-splash source window and used the current seven-page long-form PDF structure.
- Reviewed August 10 Part 1, Part 2, and Part 3 because they are the closest recent examples of same-day part-numbered documentation with committed source windows and separate PDF-only worklog commits.
- Reviewed July 7 Part 1 through Part 3 as older same-day precedents for maintaining continuity when a single date accumulates multiple implementation sessions.
- Checked git history after the first August 12 worklog, using `5a7db8e..edcee75` as the source range for this Part 2 narrative.
- Inspected the `edcee75` commit message, name-status output, and changed-file list to ground this artifact in actual tracked files rather than session memory alone.
- Reviewed `mob/components/QuestionOverlay.js`, `mob/components/SwipeLeftAnimatic.js`, `mob/scripts/clean_smiley_storyboard_assets.py`, `mob/app/_layout.js`, `mob/babel.config.js`, `mob/package.json`, the native splash config plugin, `requirements-dev.txt`, and the imported tutorial storyboard asset tree.
- Confirmed the repository was clean at `main...origin/main` before this documentation pass began, meaning the animation source work described here had already been committed and synced.

Baseline Status Before August 12 Part 2

- The August 12 Part 1 source window had already replaced the old startup question-splash path with an orange-gradient Play Store icon splash, readiness-gated timing, native blank-orange first frame, and a smooth transition into tutorial overlay 1.
- The startup tutorial still used the five-step QuestionOverlay flow, with step 5 showing the delivery/arrival visual and a Got It CTA before entering the actual Home screen.
- Before Part 2, the Got It interaction closed the startup tutorial without playing the user-provided exact smiley storyboard animation sequence.
- The exact_smiley_storyboard_frames_with_readme folder existed on the user's Desktop as the source art to import, clean, and adapt for the tutorial step 5 finish animation.
- The mobile app had not yet installed React Native Reanimated or Worklets in this project state, so the animation needed both a JavaScript integration and the native runtime pieces needed by the Android development build.
- The source storyboard images contained numbered bubbles, grainy or uneven background gradients around the character, and frame-to-frame differences that made naive image swapping read like a slideshow.
- Android testing relied on the generated native project under mob/android, which remains ignored by git; persistent native behavior therefore needed to live in tracked Expo config/plugin source where possible.
- The earlier Android edge-to-edge console warnings from Expo navigation-bar color calls were visible during runtime relaunch checks and needed to be separated from the Worklets/Reanimated issue.
- No checkout backend, Stripe payment flow, product data, Play Store screenshot marketing assets, public website behavior, or server deployment path was intended to change during this Part 2 window.

Goals for August 12 Part 2

- Import the exact smiley storyboard source folder into the mobile project under an appropriate tutorial asset location and preserve its README/source-frame context.
- Use the imported smiley files as the tutorial step 5 Got It animation rather than as a separate app screen, marketing asset, or static illustration.
- Make the Got It button start from the static frame 1 image, play through the smiley frames once in a smooth motion, then hold the final smile frame before transitioning into Home.
- Avoid navigating to Home until the animation has completed and the final hold has elapsed, while disabling repeat taps and tutorial swipes during the exit animation.
- Install the right animation dependency for the React Native app, configure it correctly, and rebuild/reinstall Android so native Worklets support is actually present.
- Install Pillow and use it to clean the exact raster assets, remove the numbered bubbles, smooth ugly gradients, and generate animation-ready output while keeping the graphic recognizably identical.
- Move beyond a slideshow effect by producing intermediate frames, a single sprite atlas, and Reanimated-driven frame selection instead of swapping six independent images at coarse timing points.
- Fix the user-reported white left-side block near the smiling emoji and the awkward stutter/flicker near the end of the Got It animation.
- Keep the existing looping two-swipe hand hint on tutorial overlays, but remove the strange reset flash that appeared after each two-swipe burst.

- Leave generated native folders and transient diagnostic animation frames out of git while keeping the source assets, generator, final sprite, and development dependency record tracked.

Work Completed - Storyboard Import and Tutorial Asset Placement

- Imported the user-provided exact smiley storyboard material from the Desktop folder into mob/assets/tutorial/smiley-got-it-storyboard, matching its intended role as tutorial artwork rather than general store artwork.
- Kept the original eight storyboard PNGs in the asset directory as source frames, preserving the exact source art for future regeneration passes and review.
- Preserved the imported README.md alongside the frames so the source folder remains understandable from inside the repository.
- Added cleaned frame outputs under cleaned/, generated reusable animated layer outputs under animated_layers/, and placed the production sprite atlas under smooth/smiley_got_it_sprite.png.
- Kept diagnostic smooth/sprite_frame_*.png files generated locally for visual QA, then ignored those frame-by-frame diagnostics in git so the repository tracks the final sprite atlas without accumulating generated review frames.
- Verified the final sprite atlas dimensions after padding as 3136 x 3120, reflecting an 8-column by 6-row sheet with 48 animation frames and transparent gutters around each 384 x 512 storyboard frame.

Work Completed - Pillow Cleanup and Sprite Generation Pipeline

- Installed Pillow for the development asset-generation workflow and recorded Pillow==12.3.0 in requirements-dev.txt so future regeneration uses a known image-processing dependency.
- Added mob/scripts/clean_smiley_storyboard_assets.py as a deterministic Pillow pipeline for reading the source frames, removing numbered badges, masking foreground artwork, smoothing rough background/gradient artifacts, and writing cleaned RGBA frame outputs.
- Implemented component extraction and mask-building helpers for face, hand, sparkle, and foreground regions so the animation can be built from layered art instead of crossfading whole screenshots.
- Generated face_rest, face_mid, face_closed, face_grin, hand, and sparkle layer assets from the cleaned storyboard material and aligned them around the face center for smoother composition.
- Built 48 intermediate sprite frames from the six main layer/keyframe states, using easing, opacity windows, hand motion, sparkle reveal, subtle face scale/translation, and final settling rather than coarse six-image swapping.
- Removed the generator's hand-shaped subtraction from smile face masks after it produced the visible white block/box on the left side of the smiling emoji.
- Removed the final crossfade into a different cleaned frame after visual inspection showed it caused a mismatched last-second blend and an end-of-animation stutter/flicker.
- Added a 4px transparent gutter around every atlas cell so Android texture sampling during scaling cannot bleed neighboring-frame pixels into the clipped visible viewport.
- Generated contact sheets and zoom diagnostics during the repair passes to inspect smile frames, source layers, and end frames before rebuilding the app.

Work Completed - Reanimated Got It Flow

- Installed react-native-reanimated and react-native-worklets in mob/package.json/package-lock.json so the tutorial finish animation can run on the native animation runtime rather than coarse JavaScript state swaps.
- Added the required react-native-reanimated Babel plugin to mob/babel.config.js, preserving the existing Expo preset while enabling worklet compilation.
- Added a QuestionGuideSmileyStoryboardVisual component in QuestionOverlay that renders the final sprite atlas through a clipped Reanimated.Image viewport.
- Mapped the shared animation progress value to sprite-frame row/column offsets across 48 generated frames, including the padded-cell math needed for the atlas gutters.
- Kept the visible storyboard aspect ratio anchored to the original 384 x 512 frame dimensions while letting the padded atlas cell dimensions remain invisible outside the viewport.
- Added a subtle Reanimated container scale and vertical movement curve so the exit animation has a little life without changing the source artwork into a different graphic style.
- Disabled native image fade with fadeDuration={0} on the sprite image so Android does not add an unrelated fade over the frame animation.
- Prefetched the sprite asset when the splash/tutorial presentation opens so the Got It press is less likely to expose a decode/loading hitch.

Work Completed - Got It Button Timing and Navigation Gating

- Changed the splash-presentation Got It button from immediate close behavior into an animation-triggering path that starts the shared Reanimated progress at 0 and runs it to 1 over 1000ms.
- Added an isGotItAnimating state so repeat taps and overlay swipes are ignored while the exit animation is in progress.
- Used runOnJS to start the post-animation close timer only after the Reanimated timing callback finishes successfully.
- Initially held the final image for 0.5 seconds after animation completion, then updated the final hold to 1.5 seconds per the later user request.
- Kept the non-splash QuestionOverlay behavior intact: ordinary shop/help overlay usage can still close without playing the startup-only smiley storyboard animation.
- Reset animation progress, cancel active animations, clear pending close timers, and restore button state whenever the overlay visibility changes or the component unmounts.
- Updated the startup Got It button accessibility label to Finish startup tutorial while preserving Close questions overlay for the normal non-splash path.
- Verified through emulator captures that the app remained on the tutorial during the animation and final hold, then transitioned into Home only after the animation and hold completed.

Work Completed - Android Runtime and Native Launch Stability

- Rebuilt the generated Android debug project after installing Reanimated/Worklets because force-stopping and restarting the installed app alone cannot add newly required native libraries.
- Verified Android Worklets startup through logcat, including libworklets.so loading successfully from the installed debug APK.
- Separated the earlier native-parts-of-worklets runtime failure from unrelated Expo navigation-bar edge-to-edge warnings, avoiding a misleading Gradle/Kotlin diagnosis for what was ultimately React Native runtime integration.

- Removed unsupported `NavigationBar.setBackgroundColorAsync` and `NavigationBar.setBorderColorAsync` calls from `mob/app/_layout.js` after they repeatedly produced edge-to-edge warning noise in React Native DevTools.
- Kept `NavigationBar` visibility and button-style handling intact so the system navigation behavior still follows the app's Android startup and overlay needs.
- Extended the tracked Android blank-native-splash plugin so future regenerated native projects write `splashscreen_background.xml` in addition to the launcher background and transparent icon resources.
- Left `mob/android` and `mob/ios` ignored as generated native projects while keeping the source plugin changes tracked, matching the project's managed/generator workflow.

Work Completed - Swipe Hint Reset Cleanup

- Investigated the tutorial overlay swipe-hand animatic after it began flashing briefly after the two expected swipe motions completed.
- Found the reset-order issue in `SwipeLeftAnimatic`: progress was reset to the start position while visibility was still 1, exposing one split-second hand frame before the hint disappeared.
- Kept the existing two-swipe burst loop, cycle delay, travel distance, finger opacity, and swoosh behavior unchanged.
- Changed the end-of-burst sequence so visibility drops back to the resting opacity before progress resets to 0.
- Confirmed the loop now remains: wait, swipe, swipe, hide, reset, repeat, without the extra visible reset flash.

Work Completed - Project Snapshots and Repository Hygiene

- Refreshed `alla_vostra_APP_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` after the mobile source and asset changes so the app snapshot includes the new tutorial asset tree, new script, dependency changes, and updated `QuestionOverlay` implementation.
- Refreshed `alla_vostra_WEB_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` in the same source commit, preserving the project convention that app and web snapshots move together when the root project state is refreshed.
- Updated `.gitignore` so `mob/android` and `mob/ios` are both treated as generated native project output, preventing future local native build output from polluting source commits.
- Ignored generated sprite diagnostic frames under `mob/assets/tutorial/smiley-got-it-storyboard/smooth/sprite_frame_*.png` while tracking the final production sprite atlas.
- Committed the completed source work as `edcee75 Added polished tutorial Got It animation flow with a detailed hyphenated commit body covering the imported assets, Pillow pipeline, Reanimated wiring, timing, flicker fixes, Android warning cleanup, gitignore changes, and snapshot refresh.`

Validation and Checks Performed

- Ran `node --check mob/components/QuestionOverlay.js` after the animation integration and after the 1.5-second final-hold update; no syntax errors were reported.
- Ran `node --check mob/components/SwipeLeftAnimatic.js` after the reset-order fix; no syntax errors were reported.
- Ran `node --check mob/app/_layout.js` after the Android navigation-bar warning cleanup; no syntax errors were reported.

- Ran `./venv/bin/python -m py_compile mob/scripts/clean_smiley_storyboard_assets.py` after editing the Pillow generator; no Python syntax errors were reported.
- Ran `./venv/bin/python mob/scripts/clean_smiley_storyboard_assets.py` repeatedly during asset cleanup and final regeneration, confirming all cleaned frames, animated layers, and the smooth sprite atlas were rebuilt successfully.
- Checked the generated atlas dimensions and transparent gutter pixels with Pillow/sips-style inspection, confirming the final production atlas was 3136 x 3120 and selected cell gutters had zero alpha.
- Built the Android debug APK from mob/android with `./gradlew :app:assembleDebug` using the configured JDK and Android SDK environment; the build completed successfully.
- Installed the rebuilt debug APK on emulator-5554, cleared app data, force-stopped, relaunched `com.allavostra.app.MainActivity`, and used adb screenshots to drive and inspect the tutorial flow.
- Confirmed through logcat that Worklets loaded cleanly and that the previous native-parts-of-worklets fatal path was no longer present after rebuild/install.
- Captured and inspected emulator screenshots of step 5 before Got It, multiple animation moments, the final smile hold, and the eventual Home screen transition.
- Confirmed the corrected Got It path showed the smiley animation, held the final frame through the late capture, and navigated to Home only afterward.
- Ran `git diff --check` over the animation/code-path files before the source commit. The only broader whitespace noise observed came from generated project snapshot text, matching the known snapshot-artifact behavior rather than an executable-code issue.
- Did not run a production EAS build, Play Console upload, Stripe payment path, Postmark email flow, Firebase rule check, or public web deployment because the Part 2 scope was mobile startup/tutorial animation, local asset generation, native debug validation, and documentation.

Files Touched During August 12 Part 2

- `.gitignore` - expanded generated native-project ignores to include mob/ios and ignored generated sprite diagnostic frames.
- `alla_vostra_APP_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` - refreshed app snapshot after the tutorial animation, asset pipeline, dependency, and source changes.
- `alla_vostra_WEB_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` - refreshed web/root project snapshot to stay aligned with the app snapshot refresh convention.
- `mob/app/_layout.js` - removed unsupported Android navigation-bar color/border calls while preserving other startup, tutorial, provider, and navigation behavior.
- `mob/assets/tutorial/smiley-got-it-storyboard/README.md` and `frame_1.png` through `frame_8.png` - added the imported exact smiley storyboard source assets.
- `mob/assets/tutorial/smiley-got-it-storyboard/cleaned/frame_1.png` through `frame_8.png` - added the Pillow-cleaned transparent-background frame outputs.
- `mob/assets/tutorial/smiley-got-it-storyboard/animated_layers/face_rest.png`, `face_mid.png`, `face_closed.png`, `face_grin.png`, `hand.png`, and `sparkle.png` - added reusable generated layer assets for smoother composition.
- `mob/assets/tutorial/smiley-got-it-storyboard/smooth/smiley_got_it_sprite.png` - added the production 48-frame padded sprite atlas used by the app.
- `mob/babel.config.js` - added the react-native-reanimated Babel plugin required for worklet compilation.

- mob/components/QuestionOverlay.js - added the Reanimated sprite renderer, startup-only Got It animation flow, disabled repeat interaction during playback, sprite prefetching, padded-atlas math, final-frame hold, and splash-only close gating.
- mob/components/SwipeLeftAnimatic.js - hid the swipe hint before resetting progress, removing the split-second reset flash while preserving the two-swipe loop.
- mob/package.json and mob/package-lock.json - added react-native-reanimated and react-native-worklets dependencies.
- mob/plugins/with-android-blank-native-splash.js - added generated splashscreen_background.xml handling for future Android native project regeneration.
- mob/scripts/clean_smiley_storyboard_assets.py - added the Pillow asset-cleanup and sprite-generation pipeline.
- requirements-dev.txt - added Pillow==12.3.0 for the local image-processing workflow.

Follow-Up Context

- Future changes to the Got It smiley animation should start by editing source frames or the Pillow generator, then regenerating smooth/smiley_got_it_sprite.png, rather than hand-editing the generated atlas.
- If the sprite looks stale on Android, rebuild and reinstall the APK; force-stop/start alone does not guarantee packaged native dependency or image-asset changes have been installed.
- If new native splash behavior is needed, update the tracked Expo config plugin rather than relying on ignored mob/android files as the long-term source of truth.
- Keep react-native-reanimated/plugin last if more Babel plugins are added later, following Reanimated's expected configuration pattern.
- The diagnostic sprite_frame_*.png files may be regenerated for inspection, but they are intentionally ignored and should not become the production animation source.
- The startup tutorial close contract is now explicit: Got It starts the animation, the app waits for the one-second animation plus the 1.5-second final hold, and only then closes into Home.
- The normal Shop question overlay remains separate from the startup tutorial path and should not inherit the smiley animation unless explicitly requested.
- The swipe-hand hint should continue looping as two motions per burst; if it flickers again, check the ordering of visibility and progress resets before changing its timing constants.
- Play Store publication timing was discussed during the session: these changes are app/source changes that can be reviewed by Google, but they do not by themselves introduce payments, policy, or data-safety scope changes beyond the existing app behavior.

Output Artifact

- Renamed the earlier root-level August 12 worklog PDF from alla_vostra_worklog_august12.pdf to alla_vostra_worklog_august12_part1.pdf so the first August 12 source window is clearly Part 1.
- Created this new root-level Part 2 worklog PDF: alla_vostra_worklog_august12_part2.pdf.
- The new file uses the established root-level naming convention, letter-size PDF format, long-form mobile-app worklog structure, standard-library creator/producer metadata, and footer style used by the recent August documentation artifacts.
- This documentation artifact intentionally records the committed edcee75 source state and does not introduce additional app behavior changes beyond the worklog rename and new PDF output.